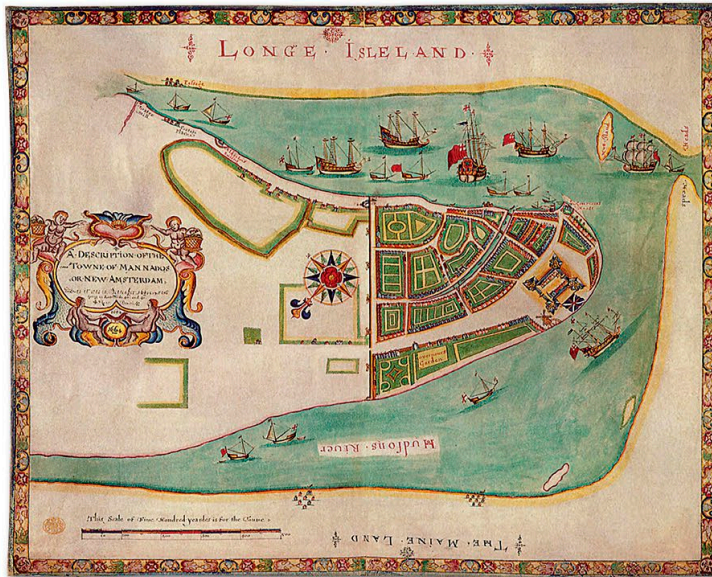




1664

BIRTH OF NEW YORK

From 1626, Manhattan Island was the site of a Dutch trading post, New Amsterdam. The settlement expanded under the energetic direction of Peter Stuyvesant. In 1664, the English sent a naval force to seize the Dutch colony. Lacking defensive resources, Stuyvesant yielded the colony without a fight. It was renamed New York after the Duke of York, heir to the British throne.

◁ Plan of New York, 1664

1665 In the Treaty of Purandar, the Marathas are forced to accept Mughal domination

1666 The death of Shah Abbas II marks the end of the golden era of Safavid Persia

1668 The Riksbank, the world's first central bank, is established in Sweden

1669

1669 Crete is conquered by the Ottoman Turks after the siege of Candia



1662
EXTINCTION OF THE DODO

The flightless dodo lived on the island of Mauritius in the Indian Ocean, which was settled by Dutch sailors in 1598. The last dodo was sighted in 1662, the species wiped out by Dutch hunters and shipborne rats. Its extinction has become a symbol of the human threat to nature.

◁ The dodo, *Raphus cucullatus*

1660-85
RESTORATION
ENGLAND



The son of executed King Charles I returned from exile in 1660, restoring the monarchy. His 25-year reign saw many dramatic events.

1661 The newly crowned King Charles II flouts puritanism, keeping mistresses and allowing playhouses to open.



1665 The Great Plague strikes London, killing one in six of the city's population. It is England's last major plague epidemic.



1666 The Great Fire of London destroys many buildings in September, clearing the way for major rebuilding in the city.



1675 The Royal Observatory at Greenwich is founded and contributes greatly to progress in astronomy and navigation.